

Great Barrier Reef

The Great Barrier Reef is the world's largest coral reef system, located in the Coral Sea off the coast of Queensland, Australia. It stretches over 2,300 kilometers and comprises thousands of individual reefs and hundreds of islands.

The reef supports an extraordinary diversity of marine life including over 1,500 species of fish, 400 species of coral, and various species of sharks, rays, dolphins, and sea turtles.

The Great Barrier Reef was designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1981 due to its outstanding ecological and biological significance. It is one of the seven natural wonders of the world.

In recent decades, the reef has faced significant threats from climate change, particularly rising ocean temperatures which cause coral bleaching. Mass bleaching events have occurred multiple times in the last decade, raising concerns about the reef's long-term survival.

Conservation efforts include the Reef 2050 Long-Term Sustainability Plan, which aims to improve water quality, reduce crown-of-thorns starfish outbreaks, and build reef resilience against climate change impacts.